

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 1
Painting the Stars ~ A Renaissance of Wonder
6 September 2026

Preaching: LVF

Worship Leading: ML & tbd

Strips of paper in programs for prayers

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Michael and ... center chancel]

Welcome

ML

Words of Gathering

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering.

***Hymn of Gathering**

[Michael center chancel]

***Prayer of Awareness**

ML

[All turn towards choir]

***Introit**

[to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

Let us now join our voices in this Lord's Prayer...

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Michael to center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

ML

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are now invited to share this greeting with those near you.

Please be seated

[to lectern]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition

This is the Gospel of Radical Love.
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph short transition ML center chancel]

Prayers with the People

ML

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

As we share these moments of silence, we are invited to write the prayers of our hearts for our lives and the life of our world on the slips of paper in our programs. If you are online, please share your prayers by emailing prayers@fccla.org.

Then, as the music begins, we are invited to come forward to share our prayers here in the bowl, and to light candles signifying our prayers, for ourselves, those we love and hold dear - and for the life of the world.

Let us now be in silence, together.

Silence

[Christoph transition out of silence as people come forward to offer prayers and light candles]

[Michael center chancel when all are seated]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Christoph transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit, choir to seats]

Sermon

A Renaissance of Wonder

LVF

[Christoph transition ... to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

FOOD AT FIRST QR Code

Offertory Anthem

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[... to lectern toward end of doxology]

***Offering Prayer**

Please be seated

[Laura & Michael center chancel]

Life at First Church

ML & LVF

Words of Blessing

LVF

Choral Response

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music